

BELONG

1. Passage anchor

> “Some people pass through your life like background noise, while others leave an echo, and she definitely ****belonged to the second group****.”

Passage meaning

****belong to a group/category**** = be correctly included or classified as part of that group

****屬於；歸入；算是……的一員****

Here, Mrs. Chan is being classified as one of the people whose influence remains with you.

Practice

1. This book ****belongs to the second category****.

這本書****屬於第二類****。

2. She clearly ****belongs to the group of teachers who leave a lasting impression****.

她顯然****屬於那種會留下深刻影響的老師****。

Core meanings of BELONG

2. belong to someone — be owned by someone

= be the property of a particular person or organization

****屬於某人；為某人所有****

Examples

1. This bag ****belongs to me****.

這個包包****是我的 / 屬於我****。

2. The building ****belongs to the university****.

這棟建築****屬於那所大學****。

This is the central ownership meaning.

3. belong to an organization / club / group

= be a member of a group or organization

****屬於；是.....的成員****

Examples

1. She ****belongs to a local sports club****.
她****是當地一個運動俱樂部的成員****。
2. He ****belongs to several professional associations****.
他****加入了幾個專業協會****。

4. belong to a category / type / class

= be correctly classified as part of a particular category

****屬於某一類；歸類為****

This is the exact passage family.

Examples

1. Whales ****belong to the group of mammals****.
鯨魚****屬於哺乳類****。
2. This example ****belongs to a different category****.
這個例子****屬於另一類****。

Appropriate place

5. belong somewhere

= be in the correct or natural place

****應該在某處；適合放在某處****

Examples

1. These books ****belong on the top shelf****.
這些書****應該放在最上層書架****。
2. That chair ****belongs in the corner****.
那張椅子****應該放在角落****。

This is not ownership. It means “this is the proper place for it.”

6. something does not belong somewhere

= be out of place or unsuitable in a particular location

不該在這裡；放錯地方

Examples

1. This file **doesn't belong in this folder**.
這個檔案**不該放在這個資料夾裡**。
2. That sentence **doesn't belong in this paragraph**.
那個句子**不適合放在這一段**。

Social acceptance / fit

7. belong — feel accepted as part of a group

= feel that you are a natural and accepted member of a community or group

有歸屬感；融入

Examples

1. It took her time to feel that she **belonged**.
她花了一些時間才覺得自己**真正融入了**。
2. Everyone wants to feel that they **belong** somewhere.
每個人都希望自己在某個地方**有歸屬感**。

This is a major abstract sense.

8. feel like you belong

= feel accepted, included, and comfortable in a group or place

覺得自己屬於這裡；感到有歸屬感

Examples

1. The team made me **feel like I belonged**.
團隊讓我**覺得自己真正融入其中**。

2. She finally **felt that she belonged** at university.

她終於在大學裡**找到了歸屬感**。

9. not belong / feel you don't belong

= feel out of place or excluded

覺得格格不入；沒有歸屬感

Examples

1. At first, I felt I **didn't belong** there.

一開始，我覺得自己在那裡**格格不入**。

2. He often felt that he **didn't belong** in the group.

他常覺得自己**不屬於那個圈子**。

Natural suitability

10. belong together

= naturally fit, match, or be associated with each other

應該放在一起；很相配

Examples

1. These two pieces **belong together**.

這兩件東西**應該放在一起**。

2. The two ideas **belong together** conceptually.

這兩個概念在邏輯上**應該放在一起理解**。

11. belong with something

= naturally fit or be grouped with something

應與.....放在一起；應歸在.....一類

Examples

1. This paragraph **belongs with the previous section**.

這一段**應該和前一節放在一起**。

2. That example ****belongs with the grammar exercises****.

那個例子****應歸在文法練習那一類****。

Time / period / style

12. belong to a period / era

= originate from or be characteristic of a particular historical period

****屬於某個時期 / 年代****

Examples

1. The painting ****belongs to the nineteenth century****.

這幅畫****屬於十九世紀****。

2. This style ****belongs to an earlier period****.

這種風格****屬於較早的時期****。

Subject / domain classification

13. belong to a field / branch / family

= be part of a larger system of classification

****屬於某領域 / 分支 / 家族****

Examples

1. This word ****belongs to the same word family****.

這個字****屬於同一個詞族****。

2. The topic ****belongs to the field of psychology****.

這個主題****屬於心理學領域****。

Very useful academically.

Possession as a rightful place

14. belong to someone — be rightfully associated with them

= properly or legitimately be theirs

****應屬於某人；理應歸某人所有****

Examples

1. The credit ****belongs to the whole team****.

這份功勞****屬於整個團隊****。

2. The final decision ****belongs to the committee****.

最終決定權****屬於委員會****。

This extends beyond physical possession.

Fixed expressions

15. belong in

= be appropriate or suitable in a place, group, or context

****適合在.....；應屬於.....****

Examples

1. That joke ****doesn't belong in a formal speech****.

那個笑話****不適合出現在正式演講中****。

2. This example ****belongs in the introduction****.

這個例子****適合放在引言部分****。

16. belong on

= properly have a place on a surface, list, page, etc.

****應放在.....上；應列在.....****

Examples

1. Your name ****belongs on the list****.

你的名字****應該列在名單上****。

2. The title ****belongs at the top of the page****.

標題****應該放在頁面頂端****。

17. belong with

= fit naturally or logically with another thing

****應與.....配在一起 / 歸在一起****

Examples

1. These notes ****belong with the research section****.

這些筆記****應該歸在研究部分****。

2. That photograph ****belongs with the others from the trip****.

那張照片****應該和旅行的其他照片放在一起****。

Related forms

18. belonging — sense of acceptance / membership

= feeling of being accepted, included, and connected

****歸屬感****

Examples

1. Students need a sense of ****belonging****.

學生需要****歸屬感****。

2. Strong communities create ****belonging****.

緊密的社群能建立****歸屬感****。

Very useful modern abstract noun.

19. sense of belonging

= feeling that you are accepted and are part of a group or place

****歸屬感****

Examples

1. Friendships gave her a stronger ****sense of belonging****.

友誼讓她有更強的****歸屬感****。

2. Schools can help students develop a ****sense of belonging****.

學校可以幫助學生建立**歸屬感**。

20. belongings

= personal possessions, especially items someone carries or owns

個人物品；隨身物品；財物

Examples

1. Please take all your **belongings** with you.

請帶走你所有的**個人物品**。

2. She packed her **belongings** into two bags.

她把自己的**隨身物品**裝進兩個袋子裡。

Important

belonging and **belongings** are very different:

* **belonging** = 歸屬感

* **belongings** = 個人物品

21. belonging to

= owned by or associated with

屬於.....的

Examples

1. Items **belonging to students** should be clearly labelled.

屬於學生的物品應清楚標示。

2. We found documents **belonging to the company**.

我們找到一些**屬於公司的文件**。

This is the participial form of the verb.

Grammar patterns

22. belong to + owner

> This book **belongs to Sarah**.

= **這本書是 Sarah 的。**

Use **belong to**, not:

* **belong Sarah** ❌

23. belong to + group/category

> This word **belongs to a different category**.

= **這個字屬於另一個類別。**

Exact passage pattern.

24. belong + place expression

> This book **belongs here**.

= **這本書應該放在這裡。**

Notice that there is no **to** before **here**.

25. belong in / on / with

* belong **in** this section

* belong **on** the shelf

* belong **with** these examples

The preposition depends on the type of “proper place.”

Important grammar warning

26. belong is normally not used in the continuous

Because **belong** describes a state rather than an action, standard English normally uses:

> This bag ****belongs to me****. ✓

not:

> This bag ****is belonging to me****. ✗

Similarly:

> I ****belong to**** this club. ✓

not normally:

> I ****am belonging to**** this club. ✗

Key contrasts

27. belong to vs own

****belong to****

focuses on the thing and identifies its owner.

****own****

focuses on the owner.

Compare:

> This car ****belongs to Mia****.

> 這輛車****屬於 Mia****。

> Mia ****owns this car****.

> Mia ****擁有這輛車****。

Same basic relationship, different grammatical perspective.

28. belong to vs be part of

****belong to****

can mean be classified as or be a member of.

****be part of****

emphasizes being one component of a larger whole.

Compare:

> Whales **belong to** the mammal group.

> 鯨魚屬於哺乳類。

> The engine **is part of** the machine.

> 引擎是機器的一部分。

29. belong vs fit in

belong

= be or feel accepted as part of a group

fit in

= adapt socially so that your behavior matches the group

融入；合群

Compare:

> I finally felt I **belonged**.

> 我終於有了**歸屬感**。

> It took me time to **fit in**.

> 我花了一些時間才**融入群體**。

They overlap, but **belong** emphasizes acceptance/connection; **fit in** emphasizes social adaptation.

30. belong vs include

belong to

describes membership from the member's perspective.

include

describes containing members from the group's perspective.

Compare:

> This example **belongs to** Category A.

> 這個例子屬於 A 類。

> Category A ****includes**** this example.

> A 類包含這個例子。

31. belong vs relate to

****belong to****

= be a member, owner relation, or proper classification

****relate to****

= be connected with or relevant to

****與.....相關****

Something may ****relate to**** a category without actually ****belonging to**** it.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****belong**** is:

****have a proper connection to a person, group, category, or place****

From this develop:

Ownership

belong to someone

→ ****屬於某人****

Membership

belong to a club

→ ****是.....的成員****

Classification

belong to a category

→ ****歸屬於某類****

Proper location

belong here / belong on the shelf

→ ****應該在某處****

Social acceptance

feel you belong

→ **有歸屬感**

Natural association

belong together

→ **應在一起；相配**

Family nouns

belonging

→ **歸屬感**

belongings

→ **個人物品**

The passage uses the classification branch:

a person belongs to a group

→ **that person is correctly considered a member of that group**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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belong to someone — ownership	某物為某人或某機構所有；屬於.....
belong to a club/group	是某群體、組織或團體的成員
belong to a category/type	在分類上應歸入某一類；屬於.....
belong somewhere	某物 / 某人最適合或理應位於某處
belong in + place/context	適合放在、出現在或歸入某個地方 / 語境
belong on + surface/list	應該放在某個表面、位置或名單上
belong with + group/item	與某物自然相配、應歸在一起
belong together	彼此自然相配或應該組合在一起
feel you belong	感到自己被接受、是群體的一分子；有歸屬感
not belong	感到格格不入、不是某群體的一分子
belong to a period/era	屬於、源自或具有某個歷史時期的特徵
belong to a field/family	在學術、語言或分類系統中屬於某個領域 / 家族
credit/responsibility belongs to someone	某項功勞、責任或權利應歸某人所有
belonging	被接納並成為某個群體一分子的感覺；歸屬感
sense of belonging	對某個群體、地方或社群具有連結與被接受的感覺
belongings	某人的個人物品、財物或隨身物品

Passage recap

> “...while others leave an echo, and she definitely ****belonged to the second group****.”

Here:

****belong to**** = ****be classified as a member of a particular group****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****屬於第二類****

* ****算是第二種人****

* ****應歸在第二組****

* naturally: ****她顯然就是後面那一類人****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****belong to a group****

= ****be included or classified as a member of that group****

****屬於；歸入；是……的一員****

It does not mean ownership here.

The key contrast is:

* ****This book belongs to me.**** → 所有權：這本書是我的

* ****She belongs to the second group.**** → 分類 / 成員身分：她屬於第二類